夏利
Charlie

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流亡者
The Exiles TMOT-01

The Master of Theatrics
戏剧与戏剧

The Exiles
流亡者

Charlie: Hmmm... Mr. Fool, how much further do we have to go?
夏利：那个……弄臣先生，我们还有多久的路程?

The Fool: My dear Troupe Master Charlie, to which path are you referring?
弄臣：夏利团长，您指的是哪里的路程呢?

The Fool: For the road to paradise has long been closed, no sign of it reopening any time soon.
弄臣：我们前往天堂的路途早已关闭，遥遥无期。

The Fool: But if it's the path to hell you're after, that remains wide open, ready for our carriage to speed down and down!
弄臣：若是前往炼狱的路途，则是畅通无阻，可供马车驰骋。

Charlie: Um... N-No, that's not what I meant...
夏利：呃……不，我的意思是……

The Fool: Hah! A jest, my dear, to lighten the mood on this long journey.
弄臣：呵呵……请您别紧张，这只是个用以调节旅途无聊气氛的小小玩笑而已。

The Fool: We've an hour left till we reach our destination.
弄臣：——距离目的地还剩下一小时的路程，夏利团长。

Charlie: One... a whole hour?
夏利：一，一小时?

The Fool: You seem rather surprised.
弄臣：您似乎看上去很惊讶。

Charlie: Well... yes.
夏利：是的……

Charlie: It's only that we've already met quite a few people on our journey. I-I thought perhaps we were closer to town.
夏利：我们这一路上遇到了不少人，我本以为我们会距离城镇更近一点的。

Charlie: Also there's something else... something off about this letter...
夏利：而且，我总觉得这封信有些怪怪的……

"Dear Troupe Master Charlie: we have heard of your troupe's reputation. The folks in our city wish to see you perform at our upcoming festival in five day's time."
“尊敬的夏利团长：久闻剧团大名，本市全体市民希望能有幸邀请剧团于五日后的节庆上演出。”

Charlie: It's all-together strange, isn't it? Who invites a theater troupe to perform at a time like this?!
夏利：太奇怪了！怎么会有人这个时候邀请剧团前往演出呢?

The Fool: More surprising is that you received the invitation at all.
弄臣：倒不如说，我反而对如今您只能收到这样一封信函而感到惊讶。

The Fool: Only a few years back, we'd have enough of these letters to fill a wall.
弄臣：在几年前，这类邀请函多得足够堆砌起一面墙壁。

Charlie: But that's... that's long since past...
夏利：那也是以前的事情了……

Charlie: With all theater prohibited... Sending a letter like this is b-brave...
夏利：现在戏剧已经被全面禁止了……在这个时候发来这种邀请函，简直就是……

The Fool: Brave indeed. Openly defying the ban.
弄臣：简直就是——明目张胆地对抗禁令。

The Fool: But my dear Troupe Master, new laws do not restrain desires, they only make new lawbreakers.
弄臣：夏利团长，禁令能够禁止的只是人们的行为，而非欲望。

The Fool: It is only right that we respond to the people's desires, whether there be a law or not.
弄臣：而在这种时刻，我们更应当回应人们的愿望。

Charlie: But...
夏利：但——

The Fool: Did we not all agree on this decision, the whole troupe, including you?
弄臣：这是剧团所有人一致决定的结果，您也予以了认可。

Charlie: Still, I feel like we shouldn't go... What if it's a trap?!
夏利：哎，我还是觉得我们不应该去的……这说不定是个陷阱！

Soldier: ...
士兵：……

Soldier: Pardon me, would you be the actors from the People's Troupe?
士兵：请问阁下是民众剧团的演员吗？

Charlie: S-soldiers!
夏利：士，士兵?！

Charlie: It is a trap! These soldiers m-must be here to arrest us!
夏利：咿呀呀！我就说是陷阱了！连逮捕我们的士兵都派过来了！

Charlie: Run away! Run away!
夏利：快，快逃！

The Fool: Wait, Troupe Master, no need to panic. These fine chaps don't seem interested in starting a fight.
弄臣：无需恐慌，团长，对方似乎并没有激起冲突的意愿。

A middle-aged man steps forward from among the soldiers.
一名中年人从士兵的身后走出。

Jeffrey: Allow me to introduce myself. I am Jeffrey, we're here to welcome you on behalf of Autonoma.
杰弗里：请允许自我介绍一下，我是代表自治市前来迎接各位的杰弗里。

Jeffrey: Mr. Fool and I are acquainted; I believe he can attest to my identity.
杰弗里：我与弄臣先生曾是相识，我想他能够证实我的身份。

Charlie: Huh? S-so you're not here to arrest us?
夏利：诶？原，原来不是来逮捕我们的追兵吗？

Jeffrey: Of course not! Why I'm as big a fan of your troupe as anyone else! Why would we do that?
杰弗里：您说笑了，我本人也是剧团的忠实拥趸，怎么会做出这种事情。

Jeffrey: You must have seen all the people heading this way. They're local farmers and craftsmen on the way to Autonama for the festival.
杰弗里：这一路上的行人的目的地与您的是一致的。他们都是这附近的农民与手工业者，准备前往自治市参与节庆。

Charlie: Oh, yes... of course, like it said in the letter- still having a festival at this time feels a bit...
夏利： 我虽然已经在信中知道了这件事情，但在这个时间举办节庆也太过……

Jeffrey: Dangerous?
杰弗里： 太过冒险了?

Jeffrey: We're well aware, but this decision was made by the Mayor after weighing all the risks.
杰弗里： 您说得对，我们也很清楚这一点，但这是市长先生评估风险后得出的结论。

Jeffrey: The Mayor thinks people need something to celebrate in these troubled times.
杰弗里： 市长先生认为如今人心惶惶，正需要一场庆典来慰藉民众。

Jeffrey: To avoid clashing with the Duke's ban, we're calling this a "market fair!" At least, until the show begins.
杰弗里： 当然，为了避免与护国公的禁令产生直接冲突，我们会对外宣称这是一场“市场集会”——直到演出开始之前。

Jeffrey: We'd appreciate it if the troupe could likewise be discreet.
杰弗里： 关于这一点，还请剧团的各位代为保密。

The Fool: Why even the foolish groundhog knows to keep his head low when a hawk's on the hunt.
弄臣： 即便愚蠢如土拨鼠，亦会懂得躲避鹰隼的追击时，不当发出声响。

Jeffrey: ...That's a sharp analogy, my friend.
杰弗里： ……真是辛辣的比喻，朋友。

Jeffrey: But either way, I want to thank you for coming and for responding to our plea despite the dangers involved.
杰弗里： 但不管怎样，我都要感谢你们的到来。感谢你们冒着生命危险，回应了我们的请求。

Charlie: Y-you're too kind. We're just grateful for the chance to perform...
夏利： 您、您太客气了，我们很感谢您给予了我们演出的机会……

Jeffrey: The festival and your show will be held tomorrow. Until then, rest up and stay low.
杰弗里： 节庆与演出将在明天举行，还请各位今日暂且休整。

Jeffrey: I've arranged a place to stay and some provisions for you. Follow me.
杰弗里： 我为各位准备了休息场所与食物，请跟我来吧。

TO BE CONTINUED ...
TO BE CONTINUED …

市场集会
Only a Fete TMOT-02

Only A Fete
市场集会

As night descends the following day, the once tranquil streets burst into life, abuzz with activity.
次日的夜幕如约而至，往日沉寂的街道一转常态，变得人声鼎沸。

Bonfires crackled at the heart of the square, dispersing the chill and blending with the lively chatter, the scent of malt, and spices, to create a warmth that enveloped the whole crowd.
广场中央熊熊燃烧着的火堆驱散了寒冷，与嘈杂的人声、麦芽和香料的香气共同变为温暖的潮湿热气，落在人们的眼帘深处。

Resident: Could I have some bread? How much is it, today?
居民： 给我拿一份面包，多少钱?

Vendor: All bread and meat are absolutely free today, courtesy of the City Council.
商贩： 今天的面包与肉食由市议会提供，通通免费。

Resident: Free? But... what's going on here?
居民： 不要钱？这是怎么一回事儿……

Before he could react, the vendor had already stuffed several loaves of bread into his hands.
不待他反应过来，面前的商贩就将几块面包塞到了他的手上。

Vendor: Here's your bread. And here, take a drink on the house.
商贩： 这是面包，拿好了，我再送你一杯饮料。

The vendor bent down to pour an amber-colored ale from a nearby barrel.
随后，商贩弯下腰，从身旁的木桶中倒出了一杯琥珀色的饮料。

Resident: A drink? This almost looks like elderberry malt to me...
居民： 饮料？怎么看着像是接骨木麦芽酒，让我尝尝……

As the resident took a sip from the cup. his face lit up.
市民接过杯子，品尝了一口。

Resident: This is elderberry malt!
居民： 见鬼！这就是接骨木麦芽酒！

Resident: But, what are you doing? All liquors are banned now, even arcane brews...
居民： 你在干什么！所有酒类都已经被禁止了，神秘学酒品也不例外……

Resident: Wait... could it be, is this all to celebrate the festival?!
居民： 等等……难不成，你们是在庆祝节日?!

Vendor: Don't worry. It's only a "market fair" today, my friend.
商贩： 别害怕，这只是一场“市场集会”，我的朋友。

The vendor gave a shrug that hid their smile.
商贩耸了耸肩。

Resident: A market fair? This looks more like a celebration to me!
居民： 市场集会？可这明明是在庆祝节日！

Resident: I was wondering why they started lighting up the square. It seems to me you're celebrating Christmas again!
居民： 从刚刚开始，我就在奇怪为什么广场会立着火堆了，这明明是过往节日才有的东西！

Resident: Have you lost your minds?! Did you forget about the Duke's ban on celebrations?
居民： 你们疯了吗?！护国公明明已经宣布了庆祝圣诞节是非法行为！

Vendor: Not at all, relax friend. There's no celebration here, only a "market fair."
商贩： 所以——这只是一场“市场集会”。

The vendor slyly winked at the nervous citizen.
商贩狡黠地朝着惴惴不安的市民眨了眨眼睛。

Vendor: And this? No alcohol here. Only "fermented elderberry syrup" freshly bought from an arcanist.
商贩： 这也不是酒水，只是我们从神秘学家那儿买来的“发酵接骨木糖浆”罢了。

Resident: But it sure tastes like—
居民： 可这明明就是——

Vendor: Oy, drop the act, mate. Haven't you been waiting for a "market fair" like the rest of us?
商贩： 噢，别假正经了，老兄。你跟我们一样，都期待着这场“市场集会”，不是吗?

Resident: ...
居民：……

The citizen gazed down at the cup in his hand.
市民低头看了一眼手中的酒杯。

Resident: Well, if it's just a "market fair"... Just a 'market fair,' that's all it is...
居民：好吧，这只是一场“市场集会”……只是一场“市场集会”……

He muttered it low, as if convincing himself.
他喃喃自语，仿佛是在说服自己一般。

Raising the cup, he gulped the smooth malted drink down.
他举起酒杯，将杯中之物一饮而尽。

"Gulp, gulp, gulp..."
“咕咚咕咚咕咚——”

Resident: Ah! Haven't had elderberry malt in ages! Packs more punch than my old homemade beer!
居民：啊——好久没有喝过接骨木麦芽酒了！这可比自己偷偷酿的啤酒带劲多了！

Vendor: Remember that's "fermented elderberry syrup," mate. Drink your fill; we've got more than enough for today.
商贩：是“发酵接骨木糖浆”，朋友。喝慢点，今天饮料管够。

Resident: Oh, of course, only "syrup" how silly of me.
居民：噢，请原谅我的愚蠢。

Resident: What a wonderful "market fair" this is—all the better with some lovely "fermented elderberry syrup"!
居民：赞美“市场集会”——当然，还有我们伟大的“发酵接骨木糖浆”！

Charlie: S-So many people...
夏利：好，好多人……

Charlie: I haven't seen a place feel so... alive in ages.
夏利：我已经很久没有见到这么热闹的情景了。

The Fool: Of course, everyone's flocking here! It's in our nature, something we can't resist! Like moths to bright flame!
弄臣：人们当然会接踵而至！这是我们的天性，无法逆转的天性！

Jeffrey: We invited a great many singers and actors... Though, for obvious reasons, only a few could make it as planned.
杰弗里：我们邀请了不少歌手与演员……尽管出于各种原因，能够如约而至的人寥寥无几。

The Fool: It makes our planned performance all the more special, don't you think?
弄臣：正因为如此，这场演出才会显得格外珍贵，不是吗?

Jeffrey: You're right!
杰弗里：您说得对。

Jeffrey: I think the People's Troupe is what everyone's most looking forward to. That's why we've arranged your performance to be our grand finale.
杰弗里：民众剧团是其中最具分量、最受期待的演出者，因此我们将剧团的演出排在了最后一场。

Jeffrey: It should be a most spectacular show.
杰弗里：最为重磅的一场。

A wooden stage covered with tents stood at the square's center, poised to become the highlight of this unspoken festival.
广场的中央是一个由帐篷覆盖的木质舞台，很快，它便会化为这场心照不宣的节庆里万众瞩目的中心。

Charlie: You mean we—we're, the last performance?
夏利：我们？最后一场？

Charlie: If I'm not mistaken, our play would be...
夏利：如果我没有记错的话，我们演出的剧目是……

The Fool: Yes—You'll play an important role in it.
弄臣：是的——您会在其中扮演一个极为重要的角色。

Charlie: No, I absolutely can't do it!
夏利：不行的……我绝对不可能办得到！

Charlie: This... This is far too rash a decision! I'm sure I'll muck it up ...
夏利：这，这个决定太过草率了！我肯定会搞砸的……

The Fool: It was a collective decision, my dear Troupe Master.
弄臣：这是大家共同的决定，夏利团长。

The Fool: And we have full faith in your abilities.
弄臣：而我，也同样对您充满信心。

Old Man: Huh?
老人：嗯?

Old Man: You...you're from the King's Troupe, aren't you? Here for the "market fair" too?
老人：你们……是国王剧团的人？你们也是来参加“市场集会”的?

Charlie: Oh... Are you... talking to us?
夏利：哇啊……您，您是在跟我们说话吗?

Old Man: Of course, young lady. I've seen the King's Troupe perform, and I recognize a fair few of the faces among you.
老人：当然了，小姑娘。我曾经看过国王剧团的演出，我认出了你们其中的几位演员。

Old Man: Well, whether you were for the "King" or the "Minister" once, those titles have long been lost.
老人：唉，甭管是“国王”还是“大臣”了，它都已经不存在了。

Old Man: With all festivals and theater prohibited. Soon, your troupes may disappear altogether.
老人：而现在，居然连节日与戏剧也不被允许，也要连着一同消失。

Old Man: Festivals and theater!
老人：节日和戏剧！

Old Man: I always thought they were an untouchable part of our lives, but now, they've become unspeakable sins.
老人：我原本以为它们是我们生活理所当然的一部分，但如今，它们却成为了不被容忍的罪恶。

Old Man: No matter how I try to reason with myself, I just can't understand why...
老人：我无论怎么想，也想不明白这是为什么……

The Fool: A tyrant's sin is born of unearned glory. To keep his power and fame, he will abandon all conscience.
弄臣：暴君的光荣来自于罪恶，为了独断与声名，故而抛弃良心。

The Fool: Our existence is a mockery of the tyrant.
弄臣：而我们的存在，则是对暴君的嘲弄。

The Fool: And a tyrant cannot endure mockery.
弄臣：不被允许的嘲弄。

Charlie: Mm... Mr. Fool! You can't speak like that here!
夏利：弄，弄臣先生！这种话是不能在这种场合说的！

Old Man: I watched your performances back then when you were known as the King's Troupe.
老人：我曾经观赏过你们的表演，在你们还叫“国王剧团”的日子里。

Old Man: I saw actors dressed in splendid costumes lined up on either side. Then, the protagonist entered, greeted with thunderous applause.
老人：我看见演员们身着华服，分列两旁，主角缓缓入场，迎接他的是雷鸣般的掌声。

Old Man: Goodness, that was an outstanding play... Something I'll never forget!
老人：天啊，那真是一场杰出的戏剧，我这辈子都无法忘怀！

Old Man: The theater, props, costumes, scenery—everything was so magnificent!
老人：剧场、道具、服装、场景——所有的一切，都是如此的华丽且夺目耀眼！

Charlie: Th-thank you for your praise... I'm sorry to say, I wasn't part of the troupe at that time...
夏利：感，感谢您的称赞……但非常抱歉，我当时还没有加入剧团……

Old Man: What a pity! Those were beautiful times... So different from now.
老人：太可惜了，那可真是一段美好的日子，与现在截然不同的美好日子。

Jeffrey: I understand how you must feel. The more darker the night, the more we yearn for the daylight long past.
杰弗里：我能够理解您的想法。现状越是窘迫，我们越是会回忆起往日。

Jeffrey: I fear we might never witness such a scene again.
杰弗里：但很遗憾，我们如今恐怕是难以再见到这幅景象了。

Old Man: Oh... You're right. Bringing it up only adds to the regret.
老人：哎……你说得对，现在说这些，只是徒增遗憾罢了。

Old Man: The king's troupe has disbanded, the old theaters will be demolished, and soon... all these splendid plays will be forgotten. With none left to remember their brilliant performances.
老人：剧团遭到解散，剧院将被拆除……恐怕要不了多久，这些曾经光彩耀人的戏剧也会遭到遗忘，到时候，又有谁会想起那些精彩的戏剧呢?

Charlie: ...
夏利：……

Charlie: T-that's not true.
夏利：……不会的。

Charlie: They will live on. Through generations, in writings and in memories.
夏利：它们不会遭到遗忘，它们将一代代地延续于纸面与记忆之中。

Charlie: They won't vanish... Not as long as people have hope in their hearts. No, they won't disappear!
夏利：它们同样也不会消失，只要人们对它们有所希冀，它们便不会消失。

Charlie: Whether it's dazzling costumes or crude rags, whether in crowded theaters or in the dark of the woods
夏利：无论是夺目的华服抑或者是粗糙的布衣，无论是在剧场还是在荒野——

Charlie: As long as people have hope, they'll hold true to their hearts' desires.
夏利：只要人们予以希冀，它们依旧能够回应人们的希冀。

Charlie: So, we'll deliver a performance just as outstanding as those of the past.
夏利：因此，我们将会拿出与过往同等杰出的表演。

Charlie: No, more! I vow to you that we'll deliver a performance that surpasses all expectations.
夏利：——不，我向您许诺，我们将会拿出足以超越以往的表演。

The Fool: I vouch for this with all the skill and artistry I have left to give.
弄臣：我同样可以向您保证这一点，以我如今还有的一切起誓。

Old Man: ...!
老人：……！

Old Man: I see now...
老人：原来如此……

Old Man: The theater isn't about splendid costumes, but each actor's performance, the heart they bring to their role—A simple truth, long forgotten.
老人：戏剧并非是因为华服道具而生彩的，而是因为演员们的演出——我居然忘记了这种常识。

Old Man: I underestimated your determination... I will look forward to your performance tonight, young lady.
老人：是我小瞧了你们的决心……我非常期待你今晚的演出，小姑娘。

The old man's eyes sparkled as if a star was reborn in his eyes, and he smiled as he left the square.
老人的眼睛里重新有了光彩，他露出了笑容，离开了广场。

The Fool: A splendid monologue, Troupe Master Charlie.
弄臣：相当精彩的对白，夏利团长。

Charlie: ...
夏利：……

Charlie: ...
夏利：……

Charlie: I-I just... What was I even saying?!
夏利：我刚刚，我刚刚到底在说什么啊！

Charlie: Bwaahhh... I'm so embarrassed...
夏利：呜呜呜……好羞耻啊……

Jeffrey: You shouldn't be. I'm sure of it now your troupe's performance will win over everyone.
杰弗里：不，您说得很对，我相信剧团的演出足以征服所有人。

Jeffrey: As the master of ceremonies, I should apologize, for putting you in the limelight but—
杰弗里：作为主办者，我要为自己的轻视而道歉。

The Fool: It is plain to see everyone has high hopes for us, Troupe Master Charlie.
弄臣：所有人都对我们寄予厚望，夏利团长。

Charlie: Waaahhh... The pressure— it's too much! My stomach is turning...
夏利：呜呜，压力好大……我的肚子要疼起来了……

The Fool: And yet the show must go on, my dear Troupe Master!
弄臣：众人都在期待着一场演出。

The Fool: As performers, it's our sacred mission to channel the audience's enthusiasm into our very best performance.
弄臣：演出者理应回应观众们的热情，为他们献上最为杰出的表演。

Charlie: Waaah! Make all the claims you like... But, if we mess up, we're done for!
夏利：呜——放出这种大话，万一搞砸了，我们可就完了……

The Fool: There's no need to panic. We will step on the stage and let our performance bring smiles or tears to the people.
弄臣：无需惊慌，只需上前，以我们的表演，为人们带来欢笑或是泪水。

The Fool: It's our calling, an unspoken bond between performers and audience.
弄臣：这是我们的使命，是演出者与观众无言的合约。

Soldier: Mr. Jeffrey!
士兵：杰弗里先生！

A breathless soldier, hurries to Jeffrey's side.
一名士兵气喘吁吁地来到了杰弗里的身边。

Soldier: Mr. Jeffrey, it's all gone wrong!
士兵：杰弗里先生，不、不好了！

Jeffrey: What's wrong, soldier? Take heart, the festival is starting soon.
杰弗里：发生什么了？节庆马上就要开始了。

Soldier: It's the Duke's cavalry...
士兵：护国公的骑兵……

Soldier: The Duke's cavalry are approaching!
士兵：护国公的骑兵，马上要抵达城镇了！

Jeffrey: What?!
杰弗里：什么?!

TO BE CONTINUED ...
TO BE CONTINUED …

发丝与铅粉
The Golden Hair and the Cerussa TMOT-03

The Golden Hair And The Cerussa
发丝与铅粉

Jeffrey: This can't be happening! The festival was supposed to be a secret...
杰弗里：这不可能！节庆应该是保密的才对……

Soldier: It's true! Our reports say that the cavalry will be here soon!
士兵：情况属实！根据回报，骑兵们的目的地就是这里！

Jeffrey: Could someone have betrayed us to the Duke?
杰弗里：难不成……是有人向护国公泄露了秘密?

The Fool: Gah! That pathetic Comaetho is always taking the wind from our sails.
弄臣：啊，可悲又可恨的珂麦托【Comaetho】，夺走了我们的发丝，这叫我们如何是好。

Charlie: W-what do we do now?!
夏利：怎，怎么办！

Charlie: That must be the Duke's cavalry... Oh, no!
夏利：那可是护国公的骑兵……呜呜！

Charlie: It's time to run... Mr. Fool, we have to get out of here!
夏利：逃走……弄臣先生，我们必须赶快逃走！

Taking a deep breath, Jeffrey regained his composure.
杰弗里深吸了一口气，重新恢复了平静。

Jeffrey: Quick, inform the Mayor, and have him stall the cavalry.
杰弗里：赶快去通知市长先生，让他想办法去拖住骑兵们。

Jeffrey: Let's proceed as planned, wrap up the festival early. Performers, use the secret passages we've prepared for your escape.
杰弗里： 同时，按照先前的计划，提前结束节庆活动，让演出者们沿着准备好的密道逃走。

Soldier: Yes, sir!
士兵： 遵命！

Jeffrey: ...
杰弗里： ……

Jeffrey: As I said, Troupe Master Charlie, you'd best leave now.
杰弗里： 正如您听到的，夏利团长还请赶快离开吧。

Jeffrey: I'm truly sorry about this... None of us wanted to put your troupe at risk!
杰弗里： 我对此感到非常抱歉，出现这种情况，是我们都不愿意看见的。

Jeffrey: But if these knights catch wind of you, nothing good will come of it.
杰弗里： 要是被骑兵发现你们的行踪，可就麻烦了。

Charlie: I-I understand.
夏利： 我，我明白了。

Charlie: Mr. Fool, we've got to get everyone out now!
夏利： 弄臣先生，我们必须立刻通知大家离开这里！

Charlie: Or else they'll be right on our tails!
夏利： 否则要不了多久，我们就会被追上的！

The Fool: Too true, Troupe Master!
弄臣： 夏利团长，您所言极是。

The Fool: And if they chase us down, they'll strangle us, and hoist our bodies on flagpoles.
弄臣： 追兵们会以最快的速度追上我们，绞死我们，将我们的尸骸高悬于旗杆之上。

The Fool: "At that time, the crows will feast upon our flesh, like a most profane ritual."
弄臣： “届时，鸦群将会分食我们的皮肉，像是一场最为神圣的仪式。”

The Fool: Alas! Alack! A terrifying outcome. We must make our exit as soon as possible.
弄臣： 何等不堪的结尾，可真教人害怕——还是尽早逃跑为妙。

With the performance's scheduled debut closing in, the rest of the troupe were busy with final preparations.
距离演出预定开始的时间所剩无几，两人返回剧团时，众人正在进行最终的准备。

Troupe Member I: Troupe Master? Mr. Fool? Why are you back so soon?
剧团成员 I： 团长？弄臣？你们怎么回来了？

Charlie: Everyone...
夏利： 各位……

Clueless about what was to unfold, their fellow performers were still basking in the festive atmosphere, slow to react.
剧团成员们对即将发生的事情一无所知，仍旧沉浸在欢乐的氛围之中。

Troupe Member II: Come to check on us? Everything's set for the show!
剧团成员 II： 你们回来得正好，大家已经准备好演出所需要的东西了。

Troupe Member I: All that was left was waiting for you, hahaha!
剧团成员 I： 就差你们了，哈哈哈！

Costumes were unpacked and prepared, and makeup already painted on their faces.
演出服被珍重地从箱中取出，连同着化妆品一起被传递到每个人的手中。

The Fool: Oh my, what a cheerful sight.
弄臣：哎呀哎呀，真是一派喜庆的景象。

The Fool: Of course, our actors should be excited about hitting the stage.
弄臣：这也难怪，任何演员都应当为即将登上的舞台而激动欢呼。

The Fool: It's a shame they haven't realized yet that fate has come as a muddy palm, to smear them their careful preparations!
弄臣：只可惜，他们还未曾意识到，命运是一只泥泞的手掌，将会给予人们以失落的滋味。

Charlie: ...
夏利：……

Charlie: Everyone, I have an announcement...
夏利：各位，请听我说……

But her soft voice was quickly drowned out by the excited chatter.
低弱的声音在被众人注意到之前，就已经被淹没在了热切的讨论之中。

Troupe Member I: I'm telling you, this script will blow the audience away!
剧团成员Ⅰ：要我说，这次的剧目保准会让所有观众大吃一惊！

Troupe Member II: Too bad the stage setup's pretty basic this time...
剧团成员Ⅱ：——虽然这次舞台的条件有点简陋得过了头。

Troupe Member I: Hey, don't be picky. In these times, just getting to perform is a blessing! We've got to make do with what we have!
剧团成员Ⅰ：嘿，你可真挑剔。现在这个年头，有机会给你表演就不错了，别挑挑拣拣的。

Charlie: ...
夏利：……

Troupe Member II: I'm not being picky! It's only that I was up all night, imagining our performance!
剧团成员Ⅱ：我可没挑剔！我昨晚一直没睡好，就是期待着今天的表演呢。

Troupe Member I: I can tell! Your powder is barely covering up those dark circles—let me apply more; we can't have the audience notice.
剧团成员Ⅰ：看出来了，铅粉都没遮住你的黑眼圈——再多抹点，别让观众看出来了。

Everyone: Hahaha!
众人：哈哈哈哈哈！

The bursts of powder rising in the air as new makeup was applied caused a shimmering in the candlelight; Charlie had to swallow back what she was about to say.
化妆时扬起的铅粉在烛光下熠熠生辉，将夏利想要说出来的话又重新推回了嘴里。

The Fool: So much hesitation, Troupe Master Charlie? Is that stage fright?
弄臣：您在犹豫什么，夏利团长？

A peculiar smile slipped through his mask.
面具上露出了一个诡异的微笑。

It carried a hint of mockery and sarcasm—emotions "The Fool" had rarely laid on her.
它带着嘲弄，带着讽刺——这是不应该属于“弄臣”的情绪。

TO BE CONTINUED ...
TO BE CONTINUED …

迷宫的国王
The King in the Labyrinth TMOT-04

The King in The Labyrinth
迷宫的国王

The Fool: Come now, if we don't tell them, there will be no escaping.
弄臣：再不向他们说出那个消息，我们可就逃不掉了。

Charlie: I just don't get it.
夏利：为什么……我，我不理解。

Charlie: These things bring joy to everyone. So why does he want to take them away?
夏利：明明这些都是能够让所有人欢笑的美好事物，为什么他要将这些事物从世间剥离……

Charlie: I—I can't wrap my head around it.
夏利：我——我不明白。

The laughter around them subsided, and worried expressions began to replace smiles on the faces of the troupe.
周遭的笑声渐渐平息，剧团成员们的脸上带上了担忧的神色。

All turned up to Charlie as if realizing something.
他们望向夏利，似乎意识到了什么。

Troupe Member I: Charlie... What's happened?
剧团成员 I：团长……发生了什么?

But as Charlie opened her mouth, not a squeak emerged.
夏利张开了嘴，依旧什么也没能说出来。

Troupe Member II: ...
剧团成员 II：……

Troupe Member II: We're ready, Troupe Master.
剧团成员 II：我们做好了心理准备，团长。

But before she could speak, Jeffrey rushed in, panting heavily.
就在这时，杰弗里急匆匆地闯了进来。

Jeffrey: Troupe Master Charlie! Why aren't you ready to go? The cavalry... they're almost upon us!
杰弗里：夏利团长！你们怎么还在这里，骑兵……骑兵马上就要到了！

The Fool: So, my dear, what's holding you back?
弄臣：您究竟在犹豫着什么?

The Fool: Anxiety? Anger? Or just plain terror?
弄臣：是在害怕，还是在恐惧，抑或是愤怒?

The clown stepped onto the stage—earlier than any of the others.
小丑登上了舞台——他来得比任何一个演员都要早。

Behind that comical mask lay a heart stronger than any other.
滑稽的面具下，隐藏着比任何人都要坚韧的心。

He had made his decision already.
他早已做出决定。

Jeffrey: We have to go now, Troupe Master!
杰弗里：再不走就迟了，夏利团长!

Charlie: Why... why does he want to take it all away?
夏利：为什么……为什么他要拿走这一切……

The Fool: —Have you heard the tale of Minos?
弄臣：——您听说过米诺斯【Minos】的故事吗?

Charlie: The tale of Minos?
夏利：米诺斯的故事……?

The Fool: Yes, the tale of that famous king.
弄臣：是的，那位国王的故事。

The Fool: When the Greek prince Minos vied for the throne, he sought divine favor to prove himself the rightful king.
弄臣：名为米诺斯的希腊王子与政敌争夺王位时，为了向国民证明自己是神明选定的国王，他向神灵请求了帮助。

The Fool: "Oh, gods," he prayed, "if you support me, grant me a white bull."
弄臣：“神灵啊，倘若您支持我，便向我赐予一头白色公牛吧。”

The Fool: "Then, I will sacrifice it in your honor—this shall be our pact."
弄臣：“届时，我会将白色公牛重新献祭于您，以示尊崇——这是我们的约定。”

The Fool: The gods answered, granting him a white bull.
弄臣：于是，神灵回答了他的请求，将自己的白色公牛赐予了他。

The Fool: But greed led Minos to deceive them.
弄臣：但在获得白色公牛后，米诺斯却因为贪欲，而违背了自己的诺言。

The Fool: He sacrificed a different bull, claiming the white one for himself.
弄臣：他在向神灵祭祀时，用另外一头公牛取代了白色公牛进行献祭，以此偷梁换柱，将白色公牛据为己有。

Charlie: ...
夏利：……

The Fool: But though Minos had kept the white bull, he soon lost what he sought most, no longer was he a king recognized by all.
弄臣：是的，当米诺斯留下白色公牛之时，他便不再是所有人所共同承认的“君主”了。

The Fool: The term "tyrant" suited him better.
弄臣：“暴君”一词，则是对于他的存在的更好描述。

Charlie: Tyrant...
夏利：暴君……

The Fool: Those who play the role of a tyrant. should understand better than anyone—the nature of "him".
弄臣：您经常饰演暴君的角色，应当比谁都更清楚——“他”的本质。

The Fool: A tyrant is a monster, a towering creature.
弄臣：暴君的本质是一只怪物，一只翱翔的怪物。

Charlie: ...Unbound to his duty, unstoppable in his wrath.
夏利：……他不受制约，无人可以阻挡。

The Fool: A tyrant scorns all, seeking only power.
弄臣：暴君蔑视一切，他所求的，唯有权欲本身。

Charlie: ...He is greedy, hungry to devour everything in sight.
夏利：……他贪婪且膨胀，势必要吞噬眼前所及的一切。

The Fool: But his arrogance will bring him crashing down. For fear cannot withstand mockery.
弄臣：但总有一天，他会因为膨胀的身躯坠落于地面。

The Fool: Then, the once-terrified populace will rise, and a new king will lead them.
弄臣：到那时，恐惧的民众将会在新的国王的领导下，向这只怪物发起反抗。

The Fool: So, have you made your choice—run or stand? Live in fear or laugh in the face of death?
弄臣：那么，做出您的选择吧——逃走，抑或是反抗？苟且偷生，抑或是死亡？

Charlie: Run or stand...
夏利：逃走，抑或者是反抗……

Jeffrey: Hold on, Mr. Fool, do you mean...
杰弗里：等等，弄臣先生，难不成你想……

Jeffrey: No! That's too risky!
杰弗里：不！这太危险了！

Charlie: ...
夏利：……

The Fool: It seems you've made up your mind, Troupe Master Charlie.
弄臣：您似乎已经有了决断了，夏利团长。

Charlie: You're right, Mr. Fool; I have.
夏利：你说得对，弄臣先生。

Charlie: I do not know what day the tyrant will fall, but until then, it's our duty to resist.
夏利：暴君终有一天将会坠落于地面，在此之前，我们将承担起反抗暴君的重任。

Charlie: Is our show ready?
夏利：我们的演出，准备好开始了吗？

The Fool: All the players wait for your cue, Troupe Master.
弄臣：一切遵循您的意志，夏利团长。

The Fool bowed his head, acknowledging her command.
弄臣低下头，做出恭敬的姿态。

Charlie closed her eyes. Reopening them with a phoenix heart, ready to begin.
夏利闭上了双眼，等到再次睁开双眼之时，她的神态与气度已截然不同。

Charlie: Let the show go on!
夏利：很好，准备上台吧。

Jeffrey: Troupe Master Charlie! Don't be reckless!
杰弗里：夏利团长！这太无谋了，不要因为一时意气做出错误的决定！

Jeffrey: The rest of the citizens at the festival are under the Mayor's protection, and the cavalry have no right to harm them.
杰弗里：你们与市民不一样，市民受到市长的庇护，因此骑兵们无权审判他们。

Jeffrey: But your troupe are outlaws! They are authorized to kill you on sight!
杰弗里：但你们不同！骑兵们是有权当场杀死你们的！

The Fool: This is far from recklessness.
弄臣：这绝非无谋。

The Fool: Troupe Master Charlie made her decision long ago. She only needed a gentle nudging from The Fool.
弄臣：夏利团长的心中早有决断，她需要的，仅仅是弄臣给予的一点小小建议。

Charlie: There's no need to fear.
夏利：无需胆怯。

Charlie: Even if the tyrant brings death, we'll not stay idle in our graves!
夏利：倘若暴君给予我们死亡，我们将会自坟墓中再生。

Charlie: Should death kiss us lightly on the cheek, our struggle will be our epitaph.
夏利：当死亡再度轻吻我们的脸颊时，挣扎将会是墓志铭的注脚。

Charlie: But before that—
夏利：但在此之前——

The Fool: We'll mock the tyrant as he deserves.
弄臣：我等理应给予暴君本该获得的嘲弄。

Troupe Member I: We're ready, Troupe Master. the stage is set and the players have their mark!
剧团成员 I：我们准备好了，团长，随时都可以开始表演！

Troupe Member II: We've been running for so long, but that doesn't mean we'll keep running forever.
剧团成员 II：我们已经逃得够久了，但这并不意味着我们会一直逃下去。

Charlie: Looking upon this grand finale, where would the excitement be to flee?
夏利：在面对这个盛大的舞台时，如果继续逃走，未免也太无趣了。

Charlie: Marvelous.
夏利：很好。

Charlie: Give your best performance, and let the audience witness our struggle with their raucous applause.
夏利：拿出你们的表演，让观众以最热烈的掌声见证我们的挣扎。

The Fool: We've fled from battlefields, gallows, palaces, dungeons, and we could keep fleeing.
弄臣：我们曾经逃走过无数次，从战场，从刑场，从宫殿，从地牢，我们大可以继续逃下去。

The Fool: But we performers owe our audience a masterful performance, no matter the circumstances...
弄臣：但演出者理应回应观众们的热情，无论在何种状况下，依旧为他们献上最为杰出的演出……

The Fool: —That is our promise to them.
弄臣：——这是我们与观众的诺言。

Charlie: We shall be Theseus, not Minos who tramples on his promise.
夏利：我们会成为忒休斯，而非践踏诺言的米诺斯。

Jeffrey: ...!
杰弗里：……！

Charlie: Mr. Fool, ring the bells to announce the start of our show to the audience!
夏利：弄臣，鸣响教堂的钟声，向观众们宣告演出的开始。

Charlie: —And, of course, don't forget to invite our "special guests."
夏利：——当然，也别忘了邀请我们的“客人”们。

TO BE CONTINUED ...
TO BE CONTINUED …

沉默的钟声
The Silent Call Bell TMOT-05

The Silent Call Bell
沉默的钟声

Cavalry: Hurry! Don't let them slip away!
骑兵：快点！不要放跑了他们！

A swift squad of knights races through the streets, their torches illuminating the night.
凌厉的军士小队在街道上奔跑着，火把几近照亮了整个街道。

Cavalry: Stay indoors, everyone! Not one step out!
骑兵：所有人待在屋子里面，不准出门！

Cavalry: This time, we will catch them!
骑兵：这次一定要抓住他们！

The clash of metal armor and loud commands echoed through the streets.
金属甲胄的碰撞声与兵士的叱喝声充斥着街道。

The town square, in the heart of the city, was in disarray, with no one to be seen.
城镇中心的广场一片狼藉，却未见人影。

Until the distant bells chimed.
遥远的钟楼，传来几声零零散散的钟声。

As if declaring or beckoning:
像是宣告，像是邀请。

???: Come one, come all.
???：哈哈，恭喜诸位。

At the far end of the street, a clown with exaggerated makeup appeared, clutching a torch.
妆容夸张的小丑出现在街道的尽头，他的手里拿着一束火把。

The Fool: Congratulations! You've captured us poor souls, who've suffered so unjustly.
弄臣：恭喜你们，抓住了我们这些遭受不白之冤的可怜人了。

Cavalry: You...you're that outlaw from the wanted posters!
骑兵：你是……那个通缉令上的违反了禁令的逃犯！

The Fool: Wanted?
弄臣：禁令?

The Fool: What a laugh! Who gives meaning to those useless scraps of paper?
弄臣：真是可笑啊——究竟是谁赋予了这张废纸以意义。

Cavalry: They are the Duke's command! No one dares disobey!
骑兵：这是护国公的命令！任何人都不许违抗！

Charlie: And who gave him the power to give these commands?
夏利：那又是谁给予了他施加命令的权力呢?

A performer in elegant attire emerged on the opposite side of the street, coolly observing the multitude of knights.
身着华服的演出者出现在了街道的另一侧，冷冷地注视着人数众多的士兵。

Cavalry: What nonsense are you spouting?
骑兵：你，你在说什么胡话?

Charlie: Why, it's the people.
夏利：是人。

Charlie: They gave him that power.
夏利：是人们给予了他这份权力。

Charlie: But then he violated their trust, and he lost the power they gave him.
夏利：当他践踏与人们的约定之时，他便失去了这份权力。

Charlie: And tyrants quake at its happening—
夏利：而暴君恐惧着这件事情的发生——

Charlie: Just as King John feared Arthur, Claudius feared Hamlet, and Macbeth feared Malcolm.
夏利：就像约翰王恐惧着亚瑟，克劳狄斯恐惧着哈姆雷特，麦克白恐惧着马尔康。

Charlie: The usurper fears the true wielder of his power.
夏利：篡权者，自然是恐惧着这份权力的真正拥有者。

Charlie: He fears us—fears the true holders of that power.
夏利：他在害怕着我们——害怕着这份权力的真正拥有者。

Cavalry: Enough! Stop this deceitful talk! Seize them all!
骑兵：够了！妖言惑众！把他们都抓住！

Charlie: But first, let us savor our final act.
夏利：在此之前，不妨欣赏最后的演出吧。

Once more, the distant bells rang out.
远处钟楼的钟声再度响起。

Charlie: That is your cue, Mr. Fool.
夏利：开始吧，弄臣。

The Fool: As you wish.
弄臣：遵命。

The clown raised his torch and flung it aside.
小丑举起手里的火把，将其抛到了一旁。

Flames swiftly spread from the torch to the buildings lining both sides of the street.
火焰迅速地从火把蔓延到了街道两旁的房屋。

The fire escalated rapidly, transforming the street into an impassable wall of flames.
火焰蔓延的速度极快，很快就将街道的两旁化作了不可逾越的火墙。

Cavalry: What are you doing... have you all lost your minds?!
骑兵：这是在干什么……你们疯了吗?!

Cavalry: Quick! On my mark, turn back and retreat!
骑兵：快！所有人听令，赶快掉头撤离！

Soldier: Captain! The way back is blocked!
士兵：队长！我，我们的后路被封堵住了！

The cavalry captain turned in shock.
骑兵首领惊愕地转过头去。

Suddenly, a large crowd gathered around Charlie.
不知何时，夏利的身边出现了大量的人群。

Silent and unmoving, they stood like an impenetrable wall.
他们沉默着，像是一堵巨大的磐石。

Charlie: You thugs, did I not warn you? This is the final act—but not ours, yours.
夏利：暴徒们，我说过了，这是最后的演出——但并非我们的，而是你们的。

Charlie: Savor your last gasp of fear, for on its tail quickly comes...the anger of the people!
夏利：仔细品味你们的恐惧吧，这便是……人们的愤怒。

Soldier: Captain! There's nobody on the other side of the street. We can break through there!
士兵：队长！街道的另一侧没有人，我们可以从那边突围！

Soldier: Wait...are they forcing us to break through ahead?
士兵：等等……他们是在逼迫着我们朝着前面突围?

Cavalry: These blasted troublemakers...
骑兵：这群该死的刁民……

Soldier: I see it now!
士兵：我知道了！

Soldier: They fear the Duke's might!
士兵：他们在害怕着护国公的力量！

Soldier: They won't dare kill us! They fear the Duke's retaliation, so they're forcing us out through another gate!
士兵：他们不敢杀死我们，担心引起护国公的报复，只敢用这种方式逼迫我们从另一个城门离开！

Cavalry: What a despicable lot, daring to turn against their betters!
骑兵：闭嘴！这群下贱的东西，胆敢反抗！

Soldier: Captain, if we don't run now, it'll be too late!
士兵：队长，再不撤退的话就晚了！

As the fear heightened the cavalry leader seemed to remember something.
忽然间，骑兵首领似乎想起来了什么。

Cavalry: No, no! I won't fall for this!
骑兵：不，不！我想起来了！

A confident smile spread across his face.
他的脸上出现了自信的笑容。

Cavalry: Hah, your performance was compelling. It almost fooled me!
骑兵：呵，你的表演很精彩，险些就将我给骗过去了。

Cavalry: But alas, arcanist, your act lacked a certain spark.
骑兵：但很可惜，神秘学家，你的表演终究还是差了一点火候。

Charlie: What are you babbling on about, you up-jumped stable boy!
夏利：你想说什么，庸碌之徒?

Cavalry: I've heard of you and your arcane illusions. This is all your trick, isn't it?
骑兵：我听说过你，你的神秘学能力是制造幻象，没错吧。

Charlie: An interesting conclusion...
夏利：……有趣。

Cavalry: Hah, these flames, this crowd... They are mere illusions you created!
骑兵：哼，这些所谓的火焰和人群，一定是你制造出来的幻象！

Cavalry: You're just making a blustering show of bravado, but your nothing more than fools!
骑兵：只会虚张声势的蠢货，弄巧成拙了吧！

Charlie: ...
夏利：……

Despite delivering a pinnacle performance, Charlie's expression momentarily wavered.
即便是最为杰出的演出者，在这一瞬间，她的表情仍然出现了一瞬间的动摇。

The cavalryman revealed a smug smile, convinced he'd spotted his adversary's weakness.
骑兵露出了得意的笑容，他深信自己已经看清了对手的软弱。

Charlie: See for yourself whether it's real or an illusion.
夏利：真实抑或是幻象，你们试试不就知道了。

Cavalry: Still want to play the braggadocio, eh? Get her!
骑兵：事到如今还不肯束手就擒吗？来人，把她给我拿下！

Cavalry: You dare to resist the Duke's power with cheap illusions...
骑兵：妄图依托于幻象来抗拒护国公的力量……

Cavalry: Honestly, your actions are as laughable as your sorcery.
骑兵：不得不说，你们的行为就像你的神秘术一样可笑。

Cavalry: Get her! Take her away!
骑兵：来人，把她给我拿下！

Suddenly, the bells chimed again, but this time, they sounded unusually long, ringing out a different tune.
忽然间，钟楼的钟声再度响起，只是这次似乎与以往有所不同，不知为何显得格外的悠长。

The echoes of the bells faded, replaced by a different sound.
钟声的尾音的震颤逐渐平息，而未曾平歇的部分，最终化为了另一种声音。

The sound of footsteps.
是脚步声。

A vast thunder of steps approached from all directions, and soon, flickering torchlights dotted every alley of the street.
大量的脚步声从四面八方传来，很快地，星星点点的火把出现在了街道的每一条小巷中。

With this new crowd converged behind Charlie.
——最终，人群汇聚到了夏利的身后。

Charlie: ...!
夏利：……！

Jeffrey: Stop! I am Jeffrey from the City Council!
杰弗里：我是市议会的杰弗里议员！

Jeffrey: Your actions are hereby condemned by the Council! On behalf of the City Council of Autonoma, we order you to leave now!
杰弗里：你们的行为没有得到市议会的准允！我代表自治市市议会，向你们提出抗议，请你们立即离开！

Charlie: What's this...?!
夏利：这是……?!

Cavalry: City Council?! Do you even know who we are?!
骑兵：市议会?！你们知道我们是谁吗?！

Old Man: Nothing more than henchmen of a tyrant, get out!
老人：暴君的走狗们，滚出去！

Vendor: You're not welcome here!
商贩：这里不欢迎你们！

Resident: Leave! Leave now!
居民：离，离开这里！

As the furious crowd gathered behind Charlie, the flames on both sides of the street roared higher.
愤怒的人群聚集在夏利的身后，而街道两旁的火焰也越发旺盛。

The temperature rose, and beads of sweat formed on the henchmens' foreheads.
温度逐渐上升，汗水爬上了军士们的额头。

Soldier: C-Captain, t-this doesn't look like an illusion anymore!
士兵：队、队长，这、这看上去不像是伪造的幻象啊！

Soldier: I've never heard of any arcanist creating something like this...
士兵：我可从来没听说过制造幻象的神秘术能够做到这一步……

Cavalry: It's all an illusion, you cowards! Here, let me show you...
骑兵：只是幻象而已，让我证明给你们看……

The captain of the cavalry gritted his teeth and charged into the burning flames.
为首的骑兵咬了咬牙，冲进了一旁街道燃烧的火焰之中。

Cavalry: Damn it! It's scorching! It's- it's real fire?!
骑兵：烫死我了！该死该死！这怎么会是真实的火焰!

Charlie: Indeed! And it burns with the people's rage.
夏利：因为这是人们的愤怒。

Charlie: And should you trample on the people, then they'll reclaim their power.
夏利：倘若你们践踏与人们的约定，那么，我们将会重新拾起权力。

Charlie: That which rightfully belongs with them.
夏利：——本属于人们的、理所应当的权力。

Charlie: Respect a just ruler, but ever resist a tyrant—
夏利：给予明君敬爱，给予暴君反抗。

Charlie: This is the reckoning of the people.
夏利：这是理所当然的事情。

Charlie: Still think these angry crowds are just an illusion?
夏利：你还要试试，这些愤怒的人群是否属实吗?

Cavalry: You dare—
骑兵：你竟敢——

The cavalryman's words were cut off by a rotten egg thrown from the crowd.
骑兵的话语被某个从人群之中飞出的臭鸡蛋给打断了。

Though it bounced harmlessly from his heavy armor, the humiliation pierced him deeper than any bolt or arrow.
它不足以对厚重的铠甲造成任何实质性的伤害，但它带来的耻辱，却足以贯穿甲胄。

Charlie: Still think this is just a trick?
夏利：你还认为，这些愤怒仅仅只是幻象吗?

The bells...
钟声——

The bells rang louder and more fervently.
城市上空的钟声愈发密集，一声接着一声。

They sounded like they were urging a final judgment.
像是催促，像是审判。

The captain's spirit finally crumbled.
兵士首领的心理防线终于崩溃。

Cavalry: Madmen... a bunch of madmen!
骑兵：疯子……一群疯子！

Cavalry: How dare you rabble defy the Duke's—
骑兵：你们，你们怎么胆敢对抗护国公的……

His muttered words were consumed by the crowd's condemnation.
他的喃喃自语，很快被淹没在了人群的声讨之中。

Charlie: Don't say I didn't warn you. Leave now while you still can.
夏利：别怪我没有提醒你们，趁还来得及，赶快离开吧。

Charlie: ...Or face the fury of the people.
夏利：——否则，你们将会见识到人们真正的愤怒。

She raised a hand, and the crowd parted, creating a path behind her.
她举起了一只手，伴随着她的动作，身后的人群让出了一条通道。

Cavalry: Damn it... let's go... let's go! Retreat, retreat!
骑兵：该死的……走……我们走！撤退，撤退！

The soldiers meekly sheathed their weapons and retreated towards the city gate.
兵士们只能灰溜溜地收起武器，朝着城门方向离去。

Old Man: That's it! Don't show your faces here again!
老人：这还差不多！别再让我见到你们的脸了！

Laughter erupted among the crowd.
人群中爆发出一阵哄笑声。

The soldiers' arrogance had given way to dejection, in stark contrast to their previous bravado.
先前的趾高气昂，与此刻的垂头丧气形成了鲜明的对比。

TO BE CONTINUED ...
TO BE CONTINUED …

戏剧性
The Beauty of Theatrics TMOT-06

The Beauty of Theatrics
戏剧性

Charlie: ...
夏利：……

The cavalry left the town, dejected and broken.
骑兵们灰溜溜地离开了城镇。

As the gates closed, the bells chimed once more.
伴随着城门的落下，钟楼的钟声再度响起。

But this time, its toll was slow and drawn out.
只是，这次的钟声变得缓慢而悠长。

Charlie: They're...
夏利：走……

Charlie: They're gone...?
夏利：走了……?

Charlie staggered back as if drained of all her strength.
仿佛被抽走了身上所有的力气一般，夏利倒退了两步。

She gasped violently, filling her lungs with air.
她大口地喘息着，仿佛一条脱了水的鱼。

Charlie: T-they...really left?!
夏利：他们……真的走了?!

As she tried to compose herself, the people around her and the burning buildings lining the streets began to sway.
伴随着她的动作，她身旁的人群与街道两旁正在燃烧着的房屋也开始摇曳。

Finally, the whole scene shattered like a popped bubble, revealing the true appearance of the street.
最后，景象变为了破碎的泡沫，露出了“街道”的真实容貌。

The festive bonfire continued to blaze in the square, its flames turning the surroundings as bright as day.
——象征着节日的火堆依旧在广场上熊熊燃烧，火光将周围变为了白昼。

But only a small portion of the crowd had vanished; more people remained behind her.
但消失的人群仅仅只是一小部分，更多的人，依旧站在她的身后。

Yes, it wasn't an illusion, but rather they had been all, or almost all, too real.
——是的，这并非幻影，而是真实之物。

After a few moments of silence, a cheer erupted from the crowd.
沉寂了片刻，人群之中爆发出了巨大的欢呼声。

Old Man: We did it! I can't believe it, we actually drove them away!
老人：我，我们做到了！我不敢相信，我们居然真的赶走了他们!

Vendor: Hurrah!
商贩：万岁!

The Fool: A flawless performance, Troupe Master Charlie! A flawless performance!
弄臣：完美的演出！夏利团长，完美的演出!

The Fool: A haunting performance of unprecedented magnitude!
弄臣：啊——这等杰出的表演，真是让人心潮澎湃!

Charlie: L—Let's not talk about it anymore!
夏利：不，不要再提了!

Charlie: Oh... I... I was so scared. Just thinking about what happened... I can't stop shaking!
夏利：呜呜……我、我快吓死了，一想到刚刚的事情，我就止不住颤抖。

Jeffrey: You... You did it! You really scared off the Duke's men!
杰弗里：您、您真的办到了，您真的吓退了护国公的骑兵们!

Charlie: No... I didn't do anything at all! I might have put everyone at risk!
夏利：不……我，我什么也没有做！我甚至还有可能会连累到大家!

Charlie: If it weren't for all of you ... my poor tricks would've been exposed ...
夏利：要不是大家……恐怕我拙劣的把戏早就被拆穿了……

Old Man: There's no need to be modest. You gave us the courage to resist. We came together because of your call.
老人：无需自谦，是你给予了我们反抗的勇气，我们是在你的号召下，才走到了一起的。

Jeffrey: This is an outright victory, Troupe Master Charlie.
杰弗里：这是完完全全的胜利，夏利团长。

Jeffrey: You gave them a taste of their own medicine and taught them a lesson for all of us.
杰弗里：你让他们狠狠地吃了一个哑巴亏，替市民们好好教训了他们一顿。

Charlie: R-Really...?
夏利：真，真的吗……？

The Fool: Mr. Jeffrey was right. These knights will never reveal what happened today.
弄臣：杰弗里先生说得没错。这些士兵回去之后，必然会隐瞒今天所发生的事情。

The Fool: The tyrant's lackeys rely on lies and fear to maintain power, fearing people might discover how weak he truly is...
弄臣：暴君的走狗们依赖欺瞒的手段汲取着权力，他们唯恐人们发现自身虚弱的本质。

Jeffrey: Their actions are driven by self-interest. They won't speak of this; it would never serve their purpose.
杰弗里：支撑着他们行动的动力是利益，他们不会去宣扬这件事情，这样做只会吃力不讨好。

Charlie: That's amazing! We really did it!
夏利：太、太好了，我们做到了！

The Fool: But, Troupe Master Charlie, I must remind you of something.
弄臣：不过，夏利团长，我还是要提醒您一件事情。

The Fool: Though emotions will run high for now, please don't forget there's another act still to come.
弄臣：虽然我能够理解您的心情，但请您不要忘记了一件更为重要的事情。

Charlie: Something greater still...
夏利：更为重要的事……

Charlie: Oh!
夏利：——啊！

The Fool: Our earlier performance was but a dress rehearsal. What's comes next is the real show, the most crucial of our performances.
弄臣：刚刚的演出不过是开幕的热场。接下来，才是真正的、最为重要的演出。

The Fool: The eager crowd has already gathered; step onto the stage and answer their call.
弄臣：希冀着欢愉的人们已经接踵而来，请登上舞台，回应人们的请求吧。

With the bells tolling, their audience converged on the square from all directions.
伴随着钟声，观众们自各个方向聚集到了广场之上。

The Fool: Their faces filled with anticipation for a performance befitting the festival.
弄臣：他们的脸上带着期待，期待着一场与节日相匹配的演出。

Charlie: ...Yes, yes! You're right, Mr. Fool! Now begins the most important part of the show!
夏利：……是，是的！弄臣先生，您说得对！现在开始，才是最重要的表演！

She took a deep breath, her expression turning serious.
她深吸了一口气，脸上的神色重新变得严肃了起来。

It was the same look she always wore when she stepped onto the stage.
这是她迈向舞台时的神情，一如既往。

Charlie: Let's get started, Mr. Fool.
夏利：让我们开始吧，弄臣。

Charlie: May we echo the promise we made to our audience and let them know that the theater we cherish won't end here.
夏利：让我们回应与观众的诺言，告诉所有人，属于我们的戏剧不会在这里终结。

Charlie: Because the joy of theater can have a lasting impact.
夏利：因为，这些戏剧所带来的片刻欢愉，足以留下更为长久的余韵。

Charlie: It can overcome hardship, defeat fear, and even conquer the greed of Minos.
夏利：它足以战胜苦难，足以战胜胆怯，足以战胜米诺斯的贪欲。

Charlie: Yes, even if it's an illusion, what people experience is far from some meaningless bubble.
夏利：是的，即便是幻影，人们所经历的一切，也绝非是毫无意义的泡沫。

The Fool: That is where our little story ends. I wonder, Miss Vertin, was the story to your satisfaction?
弄臣：故事到这里就结束了，不知道您对这个故事是否满意呢，维尔汀小姐?

The Fool: You see, that is the true meaning of theater.
弄臣：您看，这就是戏剧的真谛所在。

The Fool: Whether real or illusory, people will find in the performance an inspiration to resonate with.
弄臣：无论它真实与否，人们总能在其中得到一点东西。

The Fool: Were you wondering about which play the troupe is performing?
弄臣：对了，您对剧团所演出的剧目是否感到好奇?

The Fool: If you ask me, it's still a little too early for Christmas.
弄臣：要我说，对于圣诞节而言，它作为剧目未免有点太早了，距离它真正登场的时机还有十多天。

The Fool: But for a story like this, ending it with a little comedy seemed quite fitting.
弄臣：但对于这样一个故事来说，以喜剧作为结尾恐怕是再合适不过了。

The Fool: I'm curious... What do you think?
弄臣：我很好奇……您是怎么看待它的?

The Fool: Oh, there's no need to answer. I believe deep down inside, you already know.
弄臣：噢，不必回答我，我想您早已心里有数了。

The Fool: —But all this remaining the same, I hope you enjoyed the story.
弄臣：——但无论如何，我都希望您能够喜欢这个故事。

THE END
THE END